



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Buffalo Academy
School Website: <https://buffaloacademy.net/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit Report

Executive Summary - School: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX) — <https://austinclassical.org/> - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly anchors its mission and methods in "truth, goodness, and beauty," "wisdom and virtue," and a Christian theological framework; it implements the Trivium with Latin, logic, rhetoric, great books, history (not "social studies"), memory work, chanting/singing, debate/discussion, and thesis defense; it emphasizes teachers as virtuous Christian mentors and partners closely with parents via a collaborative model and ongoing co-teacher training (see: mission and basics pages; trivium model; curriculum maps; chapel; collaborative schedule) . - Framework used: "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" keyword indicators (positive/negative) for all six categories, plus the classicality lexicon provided (terms like truth, goodness, beauty; trivium, rhetoric; chanting; Socratic/disputation; partnership with parents; etc.) .

Note on method: For each category, we: 1) Extracted keywords/phrases from the school's site/crawl. 2) Compared to the Positive/Negative keyword indicators from "Six Essential Elements" and the lexicon. 3) Counted positive vs. negative matches and estimated percent_positive and percent_coverage. 4) Assigned a rating of CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL accordingly.

—
Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations - Evidence from school materials (keywords found): - Transcendentals and virtue language: "truth, goodness, and beauty"; "wise, virtuous, and humble"; "cultivate wisdom and virtue" . - Theology integrated: "glorify Jesus Christ"; "Christian Studies"; "theological principles" (explicit), Scripture/Bible; "Christ-infused education" . - Liturgical/communal: "begin each on-campus instructional day with Chapel"; "Choir" (upper school) . - Positive/Negative indicator alignment: - Strong alignment to moral realism (truth/goodness/beauty; virtue/wisdom) and theology (faith and reason, sacred scripture). Liturgical practices present (daily chapel, choir) as called out in the Elements document and lexicon . - No negative signals (e.g., "values-neutral," "secular," "pluralistic ethics") observed. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits (distinct): ≈15 (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, Christ/Christian, Bible/Scripture, theology/theological, chapel, choir, prayer/meditation, formation, sacred, etc.) - Negative keyword hits: 0 - percent_positive: 1.00; percent_coverage: 1.00 (addresses transcendental realism, theology, liturgy) - Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal - Evidence from school materials (keywords found): - Aim/purpose: "cultivate wisdom and virtue"; "contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful"; "education ... more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose" . - Formation of the whole person (not mere information/credentialing): "educate the whole person (mind, body, soul)"; "not a traditional college preparatory institution ... our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life" . - Positive/Negative indicator alignment: - Direct match to the Elements' "Cultivation of Wisdom and Virtue," "Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, Beauty," and "Formation, not information" dimensions; avoids careerist/skills-first framing flagged as negative in the Elements doc . - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: ≈12 - Negative hits: 0 - percent_positive: 1.00; percent_coverage: 1.00 - Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum - Evidence from school materials (keywords found): - Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric; explicit structure for Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric stages; formal logic (8th), rhetoric (10th) . - Great Books and primary texts: explicit commitment to “great works of the Western tradition” with exemplars (Homer, Euclid, Dostoevsky, Dante, Thucydides, Scripture, Lincoln) and “great books/great conversation” language . - Languages/History: Latin (gr. 5–8), “History” (not “Social Studies”), biblical literacy via Christian Studies; integrated view of knowledge under theology (“interrelatedness ... under the sovereignty of God”) . - Wonder/integration/leisure: “interrelation of all knowledge,” “appreciation of beauty,” “at leisure to study and to play” (scholé concept) . - Positive/Negative indicator alignment: - Strong alignment with Elements’ Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Integrated Curriculum, Wonder; avoids “social studies” framing and “STEM-first” marketing common as negatives in the lexicon/Elements doc . - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: ≈18 (trivium terms, Latin, great books/great conversation, history, integration, beauty, leisure) - Negative hits: 0 - percent_positive: 1.00; percent_coverage: 1.00 - Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods - Evidence from school materials (keywords found): - Memory/recitation/chanting/singing: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (Grammar stage); “Songs, chants, and rhymes fill our grammar school”; choir (Upper School) . - Dialectic/discussion/debate: “debate and discussion” (Logic stage), “Thesis defense ... eloquent written and oral communication” (Rhetoric stage) . - Rhetoric practice: “Classical Rhetoric & Composition”; “Senior Thesis” . - Restfulness/leisure: “at leisure to study and to play” (conceptual scholé even if the term scholé isn’t used) . - Positive/Negative indicator alignment: - Matches Elements’ Socratic/dialectical discussion, memorization/recitation/chanting, and rhetoric/oratory outcomes; shows restfulness concept. No dominant “project-based/experiential-only” language that would signal divergence (one “National History Day Project” capstone noted, but not a pedagogy wholesale) . - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: ≈12 (recitation, chanting, singing, debate, discussion, rhetoric, thesis, leisure/play) - Negative hits: 0 - percent_positive: 1.00; percent_coverage: 0.85 (Socratic term not explicit; restfulness present conceptually) - Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 5: School Faculty - Evidence from school materials (keywords found): - Teachers as models and mentors: “professed Christians ... teach from a Christian perspective,” “model proper behavior,” “model the pursuit of knowledge in a humble way,” formative chapel with students; subject mastery and ongoing training/observation; emphasis on intellectual virtue over raw intelligence . - Positive/Negative indicator alignment: - Aligns with Elements’ “teachers as models of virtue” and “mentorship/collegiality” expectations; avoids “teacher as facilitator only” language flagged as negative in the lexicon/Elements doc . - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: ≈9 - Negative hits: 0 - percent_positive: 1.00; percent_coverage: 0.80 (portrait of teacher/student not explicit, but most faculty virtues are) - Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents and Community - Evidence from school materials (keywords found): - Parent partnership/co-teaching: “co-teachers,” “parents serve as co-teachers,” “training parents,” “collaborative model,” homeschool days guided by teachers; frequent campus tours and info meetings; robust communal life (house system, recitatio, theater, athletics, events) . - Positive/Negative indicator alignment: - Direct match to Elements’ “partnership with families” and “parent formation”; strong intentional community language. No “consumer” or “customer” framing detected. . - Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: ≈10 - Negative hits: 0 - percent_positive: 1.00; percent_coverage: 0.95 - Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment - Overall: CLASSICAL

- Rationale: All six elements meet the positive keyword indicators with high coverage and no substantive negative signals. The school’s own language mirrors the classical lexicon (truth/goodness/beauty, wisdom/virtue, Trivium, great books, Latin, debate/discussion, chanting/singing, chapel, partnership with parents) as formalized in the “Six Essential Elements” framework and the lexicon provided .

Citations (inline above) reference: - School crawl: Austin Classical School pages describing aims, Trivium/Latin/logic/rhetoric, courses, chapel/choir, collaborative schedule, and parent co-teaching (e.g.,) . - Framework: Six Essential Elements positive/negative keyword lists; classicality lexicon used to compute matches and coverage .

—

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.